



M/J Visual Art 2

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 7 · FULL YEAR

~4¼ hrs per week · 50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More artworks and projects are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in works studied and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

M/J Visual Art 2 is a creative journey through time: how art has reflected the ideas, beliefs, and cultures of people across the world. From the detailed designs of Medieval art to the dramatic energy of the Baroque, the rebirth of the Renaissance, the light and color of Impressionism, the dreamlike images of Surrealism, and the bold visuals of Pop Art, every unit pairs the artworks scholars study with a project of their own. Along the way scholars build observation, creativity, and expression — and discover their own artistic voice.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 Building Blocks and Art Appreciation (Modules 1–2)

The elements of art in practice: elements drawings, still life, and form-and-value studies, with VR building sessions.

3 Realism to Post-Impressionism (Modules 6–8)

Realist still lifes, Monet's birch trees, and a Van Gogh painting; a mid-year VR review bridges the semesters.

5 Pop Art and Year-End Galleries (Module 10)

Primary-color and digital Pop Art, a color-wheel unit, and 3D and VR mini galleries to close the year.

2 Medieval to Baroque (Modules 3–5)

Illuminated manuscripts, Renaissance perspective and city drawing, and the drama of Baroque art, each with VR gallery visits.

4 Surrealism, Fauvism, and Expressionism (Module 9+)

A surrealist self-portrait, Matisse-inspired Fauvism with foil embossing, and a remix of Munch's *The Scream*.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Each lesson includes three parts: a reflection or critique, an art project, and a VR activity.
- One artist, movement, or concept per week, paired with a hands-on project of the scholar's own.
- Live class sessions twice a week, with galleries and immersive visits on Optima's VR campus.
- Extra-credit free-art invitations appear through the year for scholars who want to make more.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes / week

≈ 50 minutes a day, Monday–Friday

- Project and studio time fill most of the scheduled minutes.
- A mid-year review bridges the semesters, and gallery projects close the year.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- Basic art supplies: unlined paper, pencils, and paint for painting projects, with anything else announced in advance.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas, plus a way to photograph finished work for submission.
- Access to Optima's VR campus — VR activities are part of every lesson.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, with live class sessions twice a week plus VR meetups, on the school's weekly schedule.